



Intel MIMO Baby Monitor

is perhaps safe to say that it is going to be too expensive, at least for the average Indian consumer's home. Still, it is worth a mention.

Sony and Toshiba also joined the fray, showcasing high-end televisions like the XBR by Sony and two other series by Toshiba.

Gaming

This is perhaps the segment that made the most noise at the CES this year. We will have to start with Valve's innovative Steam Machines. Whilst Valve, which is behind iconic games like Half Life and Counter Strike, did not show-

case any Steam Machines of its own, there were over a dozen third-party Steam Machines put on display. These machines aim to bring computer gaming to the living room

like never before.

Next up is the Razer's Project Christine that showcased a bizarre-looking modular gaming PC, which comes fitted with a custom motherboard and mineral-oil cooling system. Equally impressive is Oculus VR's Crystal Cove prototype, which is a virtual reality-based headset. It turned quite a few heads at the CES this year.



LaCIE Sphere

Best Gadgets

Pebble Steel: Pebble's smart watch was till now the only one that really looked like a watch. Somehow, the company has made it look even better by adding leather and metal straps to it. The company, which had raised \$10 million on Kickstarter for the original device, seems to be taking things to a whole new level.

Razer Nabu: This fitness tracker from the well-known gaming peripherals maker is a mix between fitness bands and smart watches. Not only can it track physical activities, it can also take calls and receive emails.

Razer Project Christine: Whilst this is only a prototype device, it is still one of the best. This futuristic-looking gaming desktop is unlike any other desktop PC ever made. It consists of a number of pod-like modules that are connected to a central tower. The tower holds the processor and the motherboard for the computer, and each of the modules have their own cooling and noise-cancellation systems. So you can add separate modules for memory, storage, Blu-ray, etc.

Steam Machines: Valve's initiative to give console gaming a whole new avenue has been accepted with smiles. The company itself is planning to launch 13 computers this year, which will all be running the SteamOS, which is an operating system designed for gaming. Add the Steam Controller and you have got a winner!

Samsung Bendable TV: Good image quality and innovative design is what places this television on the list. Indeed, there was a plethora of smart and bendable televisions showcased at the CES, but Samsung has come up with something that gives a completely different experience altogether. If only it had LG's WebOS for televisions along with it.

Worst Gadgets

Belkin Crock-Pot WeMo Smart Cooker: This is one of those gadgets that you do not need. Come to think of it, a Crock-pot is not supposed to be smart. You can adjust the settings of this cooker from anywhere using your smartphone and works with Android and iOS devices.

LaCIE Sphere: This is quite literally an out-of-the-box design. Hard drives have traditionally been box-shaped, but LaCIE decided to give it a spherical design. Here is the problem, at \$490, it is grossly over-priced and the spherical design does not really make it the best to carry.

NAVIGATE: You had GPS in your smartphones, tablets, your car and now you can have it in your jacket. This smart jacket is GPS enabled and connects to your smartphone. Feed in your destination and the jacket will guide to take a left or right through vibrations on your shoulders and LEDs on the sleeves. Really now, we prefer the old smartphone GPS better.

Weirdest Gadgets

Intel MIMO Baby: This baby monitor from Intel has been at the top of the weird gadgets list for this year's CES 2014. It runs on the Intel Edison processor and relays information about a baby to the parents. It consists of a number of sensors that monitor and relay the information to the parents' smartphones. The sensors are attached directly to the baby's clothes.

Kolibree Bluetooth toothbrush: Apparently adding Bluetooth to anything makes it more attractive. But a toothbrush? This toothbrush connects to your smartphone and relays the data collected, whilst you brush your teeth, to the device through an app. It even tells you how you are brushing your teeth!

Voyce: There was no shortage of gadgets for pets at the CES this year. This is a health and activity monitor for your dog's collar, which tracks the data for your dog's heat rate, movement and breathing. The information is sent to your smartphone through Bluetooth.

Sony Dogcams: This gadget gives new meaning to living a dog's life. Put this on your dog and these cameras will give you the dog's view of things around you.

Further, when the recently launched Sony Playstation 4 and Microsoft Xbox One appear at the bottom of a gaming roundup, it tells you how big everything else in the segment was. Not much to tell about these two either, except Sony's

Playstation Now game streaming service. This was a major announcement for gamers, which won Sony quite a few points and perhaps even fans. ●

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